EU business customers with VAT ID – status & decisions needed

Shopify → Odoo · tested in Staging + Shopify test store · 28.10.2026 · Hamza Mohsin

1. What was wrong

When an EU business customer enters a valid VAT ID at checkout, Shopify applies the reverse charge (no VAT). But the VAT ID never reached Odoo: the Emipro connector does not import it. Odoo therefore treated these customers as private customers – no VAT ID on the invoice, wrong fiscal position, sales missing from the VAT return / ZM as intra-EU deliveries.

2. What is solved (Staging, ready for Production)

Step	Result in test
VAT ID from the Shopify order is written to the customer, VIES check runs	✓ **"Intra-Community Valid"**
Order gets fiscal position "Business partner EU (with VAT ID)"	✓
Lines and invoice: 0% EU D, account 812500, VAT ID printed	✓ **(test #IQD-POS-1138, -1139)**
Private EU, German, non-EU and manual orders	✓ **unchanged**

Invoices are now formally correct. Two automation rules, can be switched off at any time.

3. Open point: what the business customer PAYS

Shopify's "Tax display" setting decides the price for business customers. Example: jacket €279.90 incl. 19% VAT for German customers.

Tax display	Business customer pays	Private customer in other EU country	Refunds?
Show as included / Show as line item *(current)*	**€279.90 (gross price, only VAT line removed)**	€279.90 everywhere	Yes, if B2B should pay net
Dynamic tax display	**€235.21 (net price, at checkout)**	net price + local VAT (e.g. HU 27% → €298.72, AT 20% → €282.25)	**Never**

> With the current setting a business customer pays about **16% more** than the net price (amount × 0.19 / 1.19). Test order #IQD-POS-1139: paid €293.89, net would be €246.97 → €46.92 more. This is what our dealers noticed.

4. Decisions needed

1. **Tax display:** switch to **Dynamic tax display** (B2B pays net automatically, EU private prices vary by country) – or keep current (B2B pays gross price, no VAT)?
2. **If we keep the current setting:** do we refund the difference to business customers (~16%), and who handles it?
3. **Past orders** where a customer with VAT ID was charged VAT (e.g. #IQD-98418, Latvia, €50.80): correct with credit note + new 0% invoice + refund? (List available.)
4. **Invoice text:** legal note "Steuerfreie innergemeinschaftliche Lieferung (§ 4 Nr. 1b UStG)" – add to the fiscal position?
5. **Go-live:** OK to activate the two automation rules in Production?

> **Recommendation:** Dynamic tax display + activate the automations. Business customers pay the correct net price, invoices are correct, no refunds needed in future. Only past orders need a one-time review.